

Plain Language Summary

Why is this project needed?

Football research studies should consistently measure and report the important effects of athletic performance training interventions. These effects are assessed using outcomes that can reflect beneficial, neutral, or unwanted changes. Outcomes can be grouped into broader areas called “outcome domains,” i.e., the ‘what’ to assess. When studies focus on different outcome domains, it becomes difficult or impossible to compare or combine their findings. This project will agree on the minimum set of outcome domains that should always be assessed in plyometric training research studies. We call this agreed-upon minimum list a “core domain set.”

What is this study about?

Athletes and sport-related professionals need the best evidence about which athletic performance training interventions work best and whether they are safe. We aim to develop a core set of outcome domains for evaluating plyometric training intervention in adult football players classified as Tier 3, 4, or 5. Tier 3 players compete at a national or regional level, Tier 4 players compete in international club tournaments, and Tier 5 players represent national teams.

What do we want to find out?

We want to find out which outcome domains are most important and should always be assessed and reported in trials of plyometric training trials involving Tier 3, 4, or 5 football players.

What will we do?

We will conduct an international consensus study in five phases:

- **Phase 1 - Identification:** We will review the literature to identify which outcome domains researchers have already assessed and reported in plyometric training studies.
- **Phase 2 - Identification:** We will talk to players and sport-related professionals in focus groups to identify outcome domains that matter to football players, coaches, and other relevant groups but may be missing from existing research.
- **Phase 3 – Winnowing and binning:** We will refine the list through online meetings to organise and group the outcome domains into a clear, manageable list.
- **Phase 4 – Prioritisation:** We will send two rounds of an online survey to players, coaches, academics, researchers, and other relevant groups to rate which outcome domains are most important.
- **Phase 5 – Consensus:** We will hold a half-day online meeting to discuss the survey results and reach agreement on the core set of outcome domains that should be assessed and reported in all future trials of plyometric training involving Tier 3, 4, or 5 football players.

